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Last week: DJIA 44544.66 ▲ 120.41 0.27% NASDAQ 19627.44 ▼ 1.6% STOXX 600 539.53 ▲ 1.8% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 14/32, yield 4.566% OIL \$72.53 ▼ \$2.13 EURO \$1.0362 YEN 155.20

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Stock futures fell** and oil prices and the value of the dollar jumped after Trump imposed tariffs on Canada and Mexico, jolting investors' outlook on the economy. **A1**

◆ **Tensions between** Tesla's working culture and local norms are set to reach German courts in a test of the company's global resistance to unionization as an initial mediation meeting nears. **B1**

◆ **Musk's** social-media company X added more brands to its suit claiming that an ad-industry coalition illegally boycotted the site. **B3**

◆ **British engineering group** Smiths plans to spin off or sell its detection-technologies business and return to shareholders as much as \$1.06 billion. **B3**

◆ **Some bond investors**, anticipating the release of the Treasury's quarterly borrowing plans, worry that it might lengthen duration, putting upward pressure on already elevated yields. **B1**

◆ **Animated film "Dog Man"** led the North American weekend box office with \$36 million in a win for distributor Universal. **B2**

◆ **More than two years** after the launch of ChatGPT, software companies still haven't found a compelling way of charging for AI tools, chief information officers say. **B1**

◆ **Prediction markets**, fresh off their success in calling the presidential election, are offering a wild array of betting contracts, testing the boundaries of taste and the law. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **Canada and Mexico** prepared to retaliate against Trump's tariffs as the U.S. and its neighbors spiraled into a trade war that threatens to hurt American consumers and upend decades of economic integration. **A1, A2**

◆ **Musk's allies moved** swiftly to exert control over vast swaths of the U.S. government, as they demand access to sensitive information at federal agencies and lay out plans to block spending. **A1**

◆ **Venezuela will take** back tens of thousands of migrants, Trump said, removing a major obstacle to his plans for mass deportations. **A3**

◆ **Rubio visited Panama** with an ultimatum for the country to curtail China's presence around the canal or face an unspecified U.S. response. **A9**

◆ **The FAA closed** two shorter runways at Reagan National Airport, further restricting air traffic to the site of last week's deadly airplane-helicopter crash. **A3**

◆ **Hamas released** three more hostages, including the first American, in a relatively subdued procession after a chaotic handover last week. **A8**

◆ **North Korean troops** appear to have been pulled back from the front lines in Russia's Kursk region after suffering heavy combat casualties. **A9**

◆ **Trump fired the director** of the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, who had been targeted by bankers. **A4**

◆ **Died: Fay Vincent**, 86, former MLB commissioner. **A7**

JOURNAL REPORT
Artificial Intelligence: AI showed me my future. **R1-6**

CONTENTS	Markets..... B9
Arts in Review..... A13	Markets Digest..... B7
Business & Finance..... B2	Opinion..... A15-17
Business News..... B3-6	Personal Journal A11-12
Crossword..... A14	Sports..... A14
Equities..... B8	U.S. News..... A2-7
Heard on Street..... B9	World News..... A8-9



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Beyoncé Wins Album of the Year



MARIO ANZONI/REUTERS

COUNTRY STAR: Beyoncé, with her daughter Blue Ivy, receives the award for Album of the Year for 'Cowboy Carter' during the 67th Annual Grammy Awards in Los Angeles Sunday night. Kendrick Lamar won Song of the Year and Record of the Year for 'Not Like Us.' **A3, WSJ.com**

Musk's Allies Seize Control Of Vast U.S. Spending Spigot

BY ALEXANDER WARD
AND GINGER ADAMS OTIS

Elon Musk's allies are moving swiftly to exert control over vast swaths of the U.S. government, as they demand access to sensitive information at federal agencies and lay out plans to block spending they deem excessive.

Musk, the billionaire adviser to President Trump who runs the Department of Government Efficiency, oversaw a successful effort by his representatives to get direct access to a payment system that distributes trillions of dollars to

Americans each year. And individuals working for DOGE accessed systems, including classified information, at the U.S. Agency for International Development following a clash with security officials.

The moves marked the start of a far-reaching campaign by Musk to upend the federal government agency by agency, according to his allies. The effort prompted outrage from Democrats—and some Republicans—who said Musk doesn't have the authority to overturn programs and spending priorities decided by Congress. They also

raised concerns about the nature of Musk's operation, which is run by individuals with ties to the tech sector who haven't been confirmed by the Senate and could benefit financially from the actions DOGE takes.

"This is completely unprecedented," said Richard Painter, the chief White House ethics lawyer under former President George W. Bush. *Please turn to page A4*

◆ **Budget pick to partner with Musk's DOGE.....A4**
◆ **Consumer watchdog's chief is fired.....A4**

DOJ Probe Trapped Russian Billions at JPMorgan

A few months after invading Ukraine, Russia sent a series of huge payments to Turkey. In short order, it transferred more than \$5 billion with the promise of more to come.

By Joe Wallace,
Costas Paris
and Jared Malsin

To the outside world, the money was to pay for Turkey's first nuclear-power plant. Decades in the making and championed by Russian leader Vladimir Putin and Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan, it was being built and financed by Russia's state atomic conglomerate.

Over in New York, the transfers caught the attention of Justice Department investigators tasked with policing Wall Street. The reason? Two of the U.S.'s pre-eminent banks, JPMorgan Chase and Citigroup, handled the flow of money.

The investigators found Russia and Turkey used the nuclear project in 2022 to dance around U.S. sanctions imposed on Russia's central bank, people familiar with the matter said. Technocrats in Moscow slipped billions of dollars through the U.S. banks into a friendly country, from which the money could bankroll Russian state initiatives.

JPMorgan and Citigroup aren't targets of the investigation, which hasn't been previously reported. However, \$2 billion of the Russian funds are trapped at JPMorgan after the U.S. government halted some of the bank transfers. *Please turn to page A9*

INSIDE



SPORTS

Luka Dončić goes to the L.A. Lakers in a trade no one saw coming. **A14**

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Investors are betting on AI companies in Wall Street's latest gold rush. **B1**

Inside Chick-fil-A's Quest To Make Fast Food Faster

The booming chicken chain aims to reinvent the drive-through with drones, 'game films'; revamping the cockpit

BY HEATHER HADDON

ROCKFORD, Ill.—The Chick-fil-A in a shopping complex was straining under a crush of customers lured by a chicken sandwich deal one recent Friday afternoon. Cars inched along two drive-through lanes while tablet-toting workers tapped in orders and others handed off bags of sandwiches and waffle fries.

Weeks later, at a high-top table in the dining room, the restaurant's operator, Philip Everett, and a few colleagues from the chain's headquarters hunched over a laptop studying the earlier mayhem. Security cameras in the

kitchen and a drone over the parking lot had captured footage of the rush, which set a new sales record for the store. At its peak, the drive-through served one car every 13 seconds.

That's an enviable achievement for any fast-food operation, but Everett figured he could shave off more seconds. Studying the images, he and the others pinpointed a couple of problems: One veteran worker was shouldering too much of the drive-through duties, and the Wi-Fi used by parking-lot order-takers didn't extend far enough.

"We hadn't understood half of what our diff- *Please turn to page A10*

The Cutthroat Game of Snagging A Pool Chair on Vacation

Travelers wake up at 4, work in shifts to secure seating in prime locations

BY TARA WEISS

When Mark Toler arrived at a resort on the island of St. Vincent in the Caribbean last spring, fellow guests advised him to rise early to secure lounge chairs by the pool overlooking the beach. No problem, Toler thought. At 8 the next morning he strode confidently to the pool, where he found rows of chairs covered with books, beach towels and bottles of sunblock.

He didn't take a chance on day two. Toler, 56, set his alarm for 4 a.m. and headed out with a flashlight to guide the way to two chairs next to the pool. He put a bottle of sunblock on each chair and went back to bed. He and his girlfriend repeated the routine for the rest

of the trip.

"We hated getting up at 4 a.m.," said Toler, of Naples, Fla. "It is a brutal payoff to have a great chair in the premium spot or at all, in some cases. If you get up at 5 or 6 you might still get a chair, just not the best one. If you get there at God-forbid 7 a.m. you might miss out altogether."

Many hotels have way more people than chairs, leaving travelers with a choice: Devise a predawn battle plan or spend your days wandering the pool deck.

For those who choose to fight for a chair, it isn't always as simple as waking up early. Night owls leave items on chairs before heading to bed, while others tip pool staff to do the early morning hunt for them. Then there is *Please turn to page A10*



Game of thrones

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